

The Coach Approach Workbook

The Four EPIC Building Blocks

When I saw my best clients transition from manager to coach in their businesses, I wondered if there were a set path or methodology other owners and managers could follow. I discovered that for people to successfully transition, they needed to use the EPIC (Education, Planning, Inspiration, and Commitment) framework and work within the four building blocks. While the book goes over the four building blocks, this workbook gives you exercises to build that framework and work within those building blocks.

In this workbook, I put the exercises in a more logical order: Inspiration, Planning, Education, and Commitment. But since IPEC doesn't mean anything, in the companion book I rearranged them in the order of the acronym.

Do these exercises yourself and get the people you coach to complete them.

Module 1

"Success is peace of mind which is a direct result of self-satisfaction in knowing you made the effort to become the best of which you are capable." Coach John Wooden

I is for Inspiration

Inspiration starts with *why* and ends with *vision*. As a leader, you must enthusiastically and clearly articulate your vision, your team's mission, and why it is important. Simon Sinek, in his famous TED Talk titled "How Great Leaders Inspire Action," says that "People don't buy what you do. They buy why you do it."

Once you are clear on your *why* and your *vision*, invest some of your time with your team finding out which parts of your *why* and your *vision* resonate with them. When you understand what makes them come to work every day, you'll be on the road to keeping them engaged. It'll be a lot easier to inspire already engaged people. It doesn't mean that they will be positive all the time. From time to time, you'll still have to push, pull, poke, prod, demand, and do whatever it takes to keep them going.

Have you ever had anyone say to you, "you'll figure it out"? And you think or say, "Thanks for nothing!" Well, this is one of those times that you must learn from doing. You'll figure it out. Get started working on your *why* and your *vision*. The workbook has exercises to get you started. Make sure you do the exercises for yourself as well, so you can inspire your clients to do the same.

Watch Simon Sinek's TED talk "How Great Leaders Inspire Vision" or read his book *Start with Why*.

Why are you doing this? What's Your Purpose? What is your Why?

My Why:

What is your vision? Write your vision down quickly. Think big. What is the legacy you want to leave? What do you want to be remembered for 100 years from now? Write it quickly and then refine it over the next six months . . . Go.

My Vision:

What is Your Mission? How are you going to accomplish your vision? Write it out in as much detail as possible.

My Mission:

What is your definition of “success”?

What are your strengths? In what areas do you excel?

What are your weaknesses? In what areas could you be better?

Based on your strengths, where do you see opportunities?

Based on your weaknesses, what could hold you back, stop you, or derail you from being successful?

What are your goals? Based on the previous exercises, make a list of your three major goals or initiatives you want to work on and review weekly. For example, I have an income goal, an investment goal, and an impact goal.

Use the 5/3/1 Goals Sheet worksheet below to guide you. Make sure that your goals are stated positively and are "SMART." Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic, with a Time frame. Example, a goal to "make more money" is not SMART. It fails the specific and time frame tests. A goal "to not be distracted by small things" should be restated as "Focus on my three most important tasks at all times." A goal of "earning \$100,000 this year" would be positive and SMART.

GOALS

Detailed GOAL Development

Step 4

Step 3

Step 1

Step 2

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Make a vision board or “dream chart” on a poster board or digitally and spend a few minutes visualizing your goals daily. (Actually put this down and go do it.)

Create a list of at least ten “I am ...” statements based on your goals. Make sure they are stated as if you have already achieved them. Keep the list somewhere you will see it every day so you can say them out loud twice daily: once first thing in the morning and last thing before you go to bed. Example: “I am one of the greatest coaches on the planet.” Or “I am easily selling \$100,000 per month.”

Pray or meditate daily.

Module 2

“Do not let what you cannot do interfere with what you can do.” Coach John Wooden

P is for Planning

In hundreds of seminars, I've asked participants, "Why don't people plan?" I've gotten all kinds of answers: fear of failure, fear of success, lazy, not enough time, scared, don't know how, it might not work. They're all excuses. I don't accept excuses. Because when I ask the same people "Do you believe that planning is important?" they all say "yes." So planning is the second key component of any successful coaching program.

I advocate a 5/3/1/90 goal setting and planning approach. What that means is you build a five-year comprehensive plan; and to help you get there, you build a three-year set of milestones, a one-year plan, and a quarterly or ninety-day plan.

People ask me all the time “why ninety days?” Ninety days is long enough to get something done and short enough to keep your eye on the ball. In the last week of every quarter, you will review your progress and complete another ninety-day plan.

Once a quarterly plan is in place, it becomes easier to hold the people you coach accountable to the plan.

5/3/1/90-Best Practices

- Actually have a five-year comprehensive plan and update it yearly.
- Use a cloud-based product that you may update regularly.
 - o You can do this yourself with our Planning Product, we can help you do your plan, or we can build your plan for you based on your input.
 - o One Page Plan Below

My Vision	
My Mission	
My Why	

My Success Criteria	My Sandbox My Brand Promise	My Unique Selling Proposition Target: Who? Offer: What?
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Top 3 Strengths	Top 3 Weaknesses
Top 3 Opportunities	Top 3 Threats

Targets	5 Year	3 Year	1 Year
Revenue			
Commissions			
Net Profit Before Tax			
Cash In Bank			

Other Key Goals			
Strategies and Activities			

My Quarterly Priority Strategies for the next 12 months

Q1: Goal:	Q2: Goal:	Q3: Goal:	Q4: Goal:

Budget:

Budget:

Budget:

Budget:

Determine your planning dates: For yearly and quarterly planning, block out a minimum of four days per year for planning. Do this off site away from your business so you will not be tempted or distracted by the day-to-day workings of your business. You may want to have a retreat with your team.

One day should be devoted to yearly planning and to complete your first quarter plan. I prefer to plan for next year late in November or Early December, but it can be done earlier in the year. Pick three other days, one in late March, one in late June , and one in late September to review progress and plan for the upcoming quarter.

My Quarterly Planning Dates:

Block out another day usually in the 2nd quarter of the year to review and update your five-year comprehensive plan.

My long-term planning date: _____

Create your quarterly plan: A plan contains activities and tactics put on a timeline—a calendar. There are many apps, planning programs, Gantt charts, etc. Choose what works for you. Below you will find a simple paper calendar plan that works great. Another simple method is to use Post-It Notes on a wall or window.

90 DAY ACTION PLAN
OCT 1, 2017-DEC 25, 2017



90 Day Goals

- ☐ **Business** 1)
 2)
 3)
- ☐ **Personal** 1)
 2)

My 90 Day Reward

☐

Wk	Beg	Weekly Action Plan	Who	Completed
1	1 OCT			
2	8 OCT			
3	15 OCT			
4	22 OCT			
5	29 OCT			
6	5 NOV			
7	12 NOV			
8	19 NOV			
		THANKSGIVING		
9	26 NOV			
10	3 DEC			
11	10 DEC			
12	17 DEC			
13	24 DEC			
		CHRISTMAS		

Module 3

“In the end, it’s all about teaching, and what I always loved about teaching was the practice. . . . teaching the players during practice was what coaching was all about for me.”

Coach John Wooden

E is for Education

Question: How many books are in the libraries? Answer: All of them.

“Education” is derived from the same word as “educate,” which means to draw out and implies bringing out of someone something greater, generally a potential or something latent. Coaching at its finest brings out potential and something latent in people. Any coaching program has to have education as a key component.

Education includes the personal improvement plan (PIP), which is designed to give the person a life path, and an education tracker.

To determine which elements go into an individual’s plan—books, videos, audios, seminars, classes—you need to look at their personal learning preferences and budget.

Complete your own PIP and an education plan.

PERSONAL IMPROVEMENT PLAN-Sample

Name:						Date:	
AREA TO IMPROVE <i>Be specific. What do you want to improve in each area?</i>		ACTION TO BE TAKEN <i>What steps do you need to take to ensure your improvement?</i>	RESOURCES <i>What training, education, or support do you need to improve?</i>		DATE TO BE COMPLETED	SUCCESS MEASURE <i>What's the goal?</i> <i>What does improvement look like?</i>	
Mental:							
Social:							
Spiritual:							
Physical:							
Family:							
Financial:							
Professional:							
Community:							
Other: _____							

Education Planner and Tracker

Name:						Date:	
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Module 4

“It’s the little details that are vital. Little things make big things happen.” Coach John Wooden

C is for Commitment

For the coach approach to work, you must make your coaching program one of your top three priorities. Otherwise, it's just another initiative that'll end up in the waste bin.

People who don't want or resist coaching will eventually get their wish, and they'll either be out of the coaching program or they'll actually be out of a job because they don't want to grow. Both parties in a coaching relationship must commit.

A large part of commitment is consistency. You will want to establish rules to ensure consistency:

- Coach on a weekly or bi-weekly schedule.
- Schedule coaching sessions on a regular day at a regular time.
- Have the same format and script at each session.
- Take great notes.
- Measure everything.

On a scale of one to ten, what is your current commitment level? _____

Alignment: “Getting Your ladders on the same wall . . .”

- 1) Have you had an alignment in the last year? _____ Are you congruent? _____
- 2) See your ActionCOACH to get properly aligned and then develop an alignment script to use with your team.
- 3) It’s important to complete the alignment verbally in a question and answer format. Remember to dig deep and learn as much as you can about what motivates them.

Sample Alignment

Goals & Vision

So what do you want out of life?

Name:

Name:

So what vision do you have for your business?

What do you feel your Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities & Threats are?

(Opportunities should play to Strengths, Weaknesses leave owner vulnerable to threats)

Preparation: It is important that both you and your client come to the coaching session prepared.

Develop a “focus sheet” for your team to complete and send ahead of their session. Here is a focus sheet you can modify.

- 1) Develop a regular coaching session script to use with you team. The coaching session can follow the focus sheet. Here is a simple coaching script:

- A. What did you accomplish? What were your wins?
- B. What were your challenges?
- C. What did you learn?
- D. What do you need from me?
- E. What are your new goals?

- 2) Review Epic Principle #5: Relationships Matter.

What is your relational/business profile? _____

What is your coachee’s profile? _____

Based on your differences, what will you have to do differently to coach them?

- 3) You may choose to do a 360-degree assessment on people you coach. I have found that it is just as easy to develop a custom questionnaire. Make sure you provide anonymity so that you get honest answers. Ask all direct reports, all people whom they communicate with, and even family members. Here is a simple questionnaire:

What are they good at?

What are they not so good at?

What environments bring out their best behaviors?

What environments bring out their worst behaviors?

Is there anything else I need to know?

Compile an anonymous report of the answers and conclusions.

Coaching: You can learn from reading a book. You can learn from having a coach. Ultimately, you need to get the actual experience. Go ahead and get started coaching your key people and,

ultimately, you'll teach them how to be great coaches. No one can do this for you.

Commit to coaching as a way of life in your company. Seek out the advice of your coaches and mentors. But understand it is your responsibility to commit to the coach approach.